

Mental Health Awareness Week at Algonquin College

ALGONQUIN COLLEGE WILL HOST MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS WEEK FROM JANUARY 27-31, 2020, ACROSS ITS OTTAWA CAMPUS. THE PROGRAM IS DESIGNED TO SUPPORT STUDENTS AND EMPLOYEES BY EMPHASIZING THE IMPORTANCE AND BENEFITS OF STAYING MENTALLY HEALTHY.

“THE PROGRAM IS DESIGNED TO PROVIDE EXTRA SUPPORT AND ENCOURAGEMENT, HELPING PEOPLE UNDERSTAND THAT WHATEVER MENTAL HEALTH CHALLENGES THEY ARE FACING, IT’S COMPLETELY NORMAL,” SAID DOUG STRINGER, MANAGER AND COUNSELLOR AT ALGONQUIN COLLEGE.

THROUGHOUT THE WEEK, DIFFERENT EVENTS WILL BE HELD EACH DAY:

- MONDAY, JAN 27: FREE LUNCHTIME YOGA (SPIRITUAL CENTRE, NEAR STUDENT COMMONS); COMMUNITY ROUND DANCE FOR WELLNESS; BOB ROSS PAINT NIGHT (RESIDENCE)
- TUESDAY, JAN 28: MEN’S SPACE; SPEED FRIENDING; COFFEE HOUSE SOCIAL
- WEDNESDAY, JAN 29: TALK HAPPY PLACE; AC PURPLE COUCH; GUEST SPEAKER: SARA BENINCASA
- THURSDAY, JAN 30: DIY BATH BOMB WORKSHOP; OPEN MIC & SPOKEN WORD NIGHT
- FRIDAY, JAN 31: WARM YOGA; SELF-CARE FRIDAY; DIY SHOWER STEAMERS

MORE DETAILS ARE AVAILABLE ON THE ALGONQUIN COLLEGE WEBSITE.

FOR THE FIRST TIME, YURIY DERKACK, MANAGER OF THE SPIRITUAL CENTRE, WILL PARTICIPATE IN MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS WEEK, LEADING MEDITATION AND YOGA SESSIONS ON MONDAY, TUESDAY, AND FRIDAY. FREE LUNCHES WILL ALSO BE PROVIDED TO ATTENDEES.

“THE MAIN GOAL IS TO HELP STUDENTS CONNECT WITH THEIR INNER SELVES AND FOCUS ON MEDITATION,” SAID DERKACK. MANY STUDENTS FACE MENTAL HEALTH CHALLENGES SUCH AS CULTURAL ADJUSTMENTS, ACADEMIC STRESS, AND LACK OF CONFIDENCE, OFTEN UNSURE HOW TO COPE.

“STUDENTS OFTEN OPEN UP ABOUT THEIR STRUGGLES, AND THE FIRST THING A COUNSELLOR TELLS THEM IS, ‘WHAT YOU’RE FEELING IS NORMAL,’” SAID STRINGER.

SOME STUDENTS WERE PREVIOUSLY UNAWARE OF THE EVENT BUT WELCOME THE INITIATIVE.

“I DIDN’T KNOW MUCH ABOUT IT, BUT IT’S GREAT THAT THE COLLEGE IS ORGANIZING SOMETHING LIKE THIS. MANY STUDENTS ARE DEALING WITH THESE ISSUES, SO THIS KIND OF AWARENESS IS IMPORTANT,” SAID TYLAR LATREILLE, AN INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS STUDENT.

“I’VE HEARD ABOUT IT, AND I THINK IT’S A GOOD IDEA. WHO DON’T USUALLY EXPRESS THEMSELVES NOW HAVE A CHANCE TO OPEN UP,” SAID ZOIEY MCPHERSON, A NURSING STUDENT.

“
IT'S
REALLY
NOT A
BIG DEAL.”

